

Northwind Grid

Battery-free load shifting for commercial buildings

Seed round — 2026

The Problem

Commercial buildings pay demand charges on their single highest 15-minute peak.

Those charges are 30-70% of a typical monthly bill.

Batteries fix it but cost \$400k+ per site and take 14 months to install.

Our Solution

Northwind Grid is a control layer that pre-cools and staggers HVAC and refrigeration loads to shave the peak without any hardware on site. Installs in 3 days over existing BMS protocols (BACnet, Modbus).

How It Works

Forecast the building's load curve 24h ahead from meter and weather data.

Solve for a dispatch schedule that keeps every zone inside its comfort band.

Push setpoints to the BMS. Fall back to native control on any fault.

Traction

41 buildings live across 6 customers.

\$780k ARR, growing 14% month over month for the last 7 months.

Average verified demand-charge reduction: 22%.

Net revenue retention 131%. Two customers expanded portfolio-wide.

Business Model

Shared savings: we take 35% of verified demand-charge reduction, measured against an IPMVP Option C baseline.

No hardware, no capex, no upfront fee. Contracts are 3 years.

Market

5.9M commercial buildings in the US.

1.1M are over 25,000 sq ft with a BMS we can reach today (SAM).

At \$9k average annual revenue per building that is a \$9.9B SAM.

Source: EIA CBECS 2018, internal pricing model.

Team

Priya Raman, CEO. 9 years at Enel X leading C&I demand response.

Tom Achebe, CTO. Built the dispatch optimizer at Voltus.

Four engineers. No commercial hires yet.

Competition

Batteries (Stem, Sunrun): higher savings, 100x the cost and install time.

Legacy demand response (Enel X, CPower): event-driven, utility-triggered only.

BMS vendors (JCI, Siemens): bundled, slow to ship, weak forecasting.

The Ask

Raising \$6M Seed.

60% engineering (protocol coverage, M&V automation).

25% go-to-market (first 3 AEs, 1 solutions engineer).

15% working capital.

24 months of runway to \$6M ARR.